The Three Buckets

In the age of AI, every role is being redefined one task at a time. The Three Buckets is a simple sorting exercise I use in my Manifesto Workshop and Leadership Sprint. List about a dozen tasks you do in a typical week. Sort each into one of the three buckets below. Over time, shift your energy from Cut toward Amplify. Your buckets will change as you grow and as the tools improve.

1 CUT Tasks AI can do now or soon

The efficiency work. Hand it to AI so you get your time back for the work that matters. Every hour saved here becomes an hour you can spend in Create or Amplify.

Examples: *first drafts, meeting notes, quick summaries, routine analysis, basic coding, scheduling, data cleanup*

2 CREATE New things you can do because of AI

The stretch work. AI makes the ceiling higher for everyone. Learn a skill you thought was out of reach, bridge an expertise gap, or take on a project that used to feel too big.

Examples: *build a prototype, learn a new field, ship an idea you could not ship alone, analyze something you never had time for*

3 AMPLIFY What is uniquely you

The work only you can do. Deep judgment, complex relationships, original ideas, your distinct strengths. This is where the time you save lets you double down. No one beats you at being you.

Examples: *coaching a team member, closing a tough deal, making a hard call, shaping culture, telling your story*

Shift your energy from Cut toward Amplify. That is where the real value lives.

No one beats you at being you.